

dismissal_evidence_20260826

BOB-206 — dismissal evidence: the uid-flattening claim, refuted by measurement

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Verdict

DISMISSED as written (§11.4.90 reason not-reproducible). The item’s central factual assertion is false on this host, and its stated consequence is inverted from what the mechanism actually produces.

1. The title’s factual claim is refuted

BOB-206’s title asserted “and the download root **IS** such a mount”. Measured:

declared locations	all six resolve onto one mount
mount	/run/media/milosvasic/DATA4TB
fstype	btrfs
options (verbatim)	rw,nosuid,nodev,relatime,ssd,discard=async,space_cache=v2,subvolid=5
uid=option	absent
per-inode uid/gid	stored — fully ownership-expressive

Scope was taken from the real resolver (ownership_scope_entries(), which expands \${QBITTORRENT_DATA_DIR} against .env), not from assuming config/owned_paths.yaml is the only input. The download root is therefore /run/media/milosvasic/DATA4TB/Downloads — **not** the /mnt/DATA default.

The only uid-flattening filesystem on this host is /boot/efi (vfat, fmask=0000, dmask=0000), which is not declared and never will be.

2. The false claim was introduced when the item was written, not by its source

docs/qa/T041/review_scope_map_20260826.md:296-299 says the download root is “a host-specific mount **whose filesystem the reviewer must not assume.**”

The preflight was careful. The item’s author (the conductor) turned that careful hedge into a positive assertion. Recorded here per §11.4.6 rather than quietly corrected: the error is in the transcription step, and the transcription step is where the same class of error has now occurred more than once this session.

3. The mechanism reproduces — the consequence inverts

probe_location() (scripts/lib/ownership.sh:299-320) reads stat -c '%u' and compares against id -u. **It has no filesystem-expressiveness guard** — that half of the hypothesis is CONFIRMED and needle-proven (findmnt 0, mountinfo 0, stat -f 0, statfs 0, fstype 0, vfat|exfat|ntfs|msdos 0, df -T 0, f_type 0 across all four ownership sources; needle probe_location = 7 hits through the identical instrument; negative control 0. The 57 raw uid= hits are **carriers** — 4 are uid= assignments, the rest PUID= prose; zero are mount-option uid=).

Driven privilege-free by shimming stat on PATH (a faithful model of factor 6 at the exact seam, since uid-flattening is “stat reports the mount uid”). Instrument proven seeing before any result was trusted: FLATTEN_UID=4242 → wrong-owner:4242; shim inert → ok.

simulated mount	verdict	correct?
vfat,uid=1000 (== operator)	ok rc=0	yes
vfat,uid=0	wrong-owner:0 rc=1 — refuses	yes
vfat,uid=100999		yes

simulated mount	verdict	correct?
	wrong-owner:100999 rc=1 — refuses	

The ok reproduces but **is not a bluff**: it occurs only when the flattened uid equals the operator's, and in exactly that case every file on the mount — including container-written ones — is accessible to the operator. The user-visible goal is met, by the mount instead of by per-file ownership. The item's blast-radius claim ("the operator still has to chown by hand") describes the uid=0 / uid=100999 cases, and those refuse correctly.

Honest limit (§11.4.3): the shim models the READ, not the WRITE. It cannot settle whether chown fails on such a mount. That residual is retained as a separate operator-gated item, not buried in this dismissal.

4. What the investigation found instead

Minted as separate items rather than left inside a dismissed one:

- **BOB-207** (critical) — `probe_location()` is **GID-blind**: repair fixes uid AND gid, the precondition verifies uid only. Live on this host, unprivileged, two commands.
- **BOB-208** (major) — the want side is unchecked; a failing `id(1)` yields a false refusal that names the correct uid as wrong.
- **BOB-209** (major) — the two stat guards are asymmetric halves; a stat failure is mislabelled unwritable; the probe temp file has no EXIT trap (§11.4.14).
- **BOB-210** (major) — `detect_rootless()`'s header promises an unverified reading can never manufacture a refusal, but `:413` emits a confident `rootful` that reaches the R3 refusal; and the shim oracle shares the code's unvalidated premise (§11.4.245).
- **BOB-211** (minor, latent + operator-gated) — vfat repair-diagnosis and `fmask/dmask` mode-contract residuals; RED needs `bindfs` (absent) or a privileged loopback.

5. Corrections owed to the T041 preflight record

The preflight was **right** that factor 6 is unguarded and untested, **right** about R4's three terms, **right** that the docker branch is unmeasured, and **careful** not to claim the download root's fstype.

It was **wrong** on one point: R4 does **not** lack a second line of defence. The FR-011 gate's Invariant 4 (`scripts/pre_build/check_cm_ownership_invariants.sh:658-888`) does read the `compose user: key`, and additionally reads the Dockerfile `USER` directive

(:855). The source states two layers exist (scripts/ownership_precondition.sh:761-765). The preflight quoted the **historical justification** for R4's creation (finding IMPORTANT-1, 2026-08-21) as if it were the current state.

6. Also verified good — recorded so it is not re-investigated

- The unknown: branch is handled **identically** at both consumers (R3 :519-531, R4 :832-836 — both a named SKIP, both return 0, neither refuses).
- ROOTLESS_VERDICT is cached at :487, so both checks consume **one** measurement — the source's own warning that the two must never refuse on different facts is honoured.
- The carrier-trap golden-FALSE fixture **exists** (tests/unit/test_ownership_rootless_detection.sh:279-308 drives name=rootless-lookalike inside a profile path and must NOT read rootless; structural guard at :396-411 uses exact field equality, not substring).
- **No test anywhere** exercises a uid-flattening filesystem — vfat/exfat/ntfs/flatten/ loopback/mkfs/losetup/bindfs/fusermount all 0 across the three ownership test files (needle probe_location = 3 in the same files).

Constraints honoured

Nothing mounted, no sudo, no pre_build_verification.sh, no commits or stages, no edits to docs/Issues.md / docs/Fixed.md / docs/workable_items.db by the verifying agent, and it stayed off the sibling stream's lan_route_auth_analyzer.py. Zero probe residue left (needle-proven the find could see).